resistance to the British. The two older Sandhu brothers stood in fierce opposition to the leadership of the Indian National Congress and were adept at garnering local support whenever the need arose. Both were radical politicians in their own right. The influence of both on Lal-Bal-Pal is clear from an article in Urdu that Bhagat Singh himself wrote, aptly titled 'Emergence of the Punjab in the Freedom Movement'. [1] There he emphasized how Punjab became a cauldron of radical politics in the early years of the twentieth century, long before Gandhianism was popular. In particular, Bhagat Singh highlights the extremist influence on his family elders of Bal Gangadhar Tilak. He refers to 'their enthusiasm at the 1906 Congress Convention in Calcutta', as a result of which 'Lokmaniya was pleased and in bidding them adieu, gave them the responsibility of strengthening the movement in the Punjab'.

When the two Sandhu brothers returned to Lahore, they immediately 'started a monthly newspaper called *Bharat Mata* to propagate their ideas'. However, they were short of money and had no financial backing from the rich. So they undertook to do everything themselves. They rang a bell and brought together a crowd in the market. There they gave a lecture 'on how foreigners had destroyed India's industry and commerce'. There followed an announcement. Within a week, a meeting would be held at the offices of the *Bharat Mata* to consider the struggle for Indian Independence. The meeting on Sunday went well. It was thereafter decided that meetings would be held every Sunday in this way. Very soon, others of greater eminence joined in. There was the national poet of Punjab, Lala Lalchand 'Phalak' as well as Lala Pindidas, Dr Ishwari Prasad and Sufi Amba Prasad, to name a few. Ajit Singh was elected president and Mahant Nandkishore was elected secretary, and their organization was christened hereafter 'Bharat Mata Society'. [2]

If Bhagat Singh carried a heavy burden of his family's rebellious streak, it was not just on account of the activities of his father and his two uncles. His family's mutinous attitude is all too visible if one chooses to look at his distant ancestors. Here it becomes all too clear that if redemption was required for this Sandhu Jat family, Bhagat Singh's family had much to be